

International Commerce in a Changing World

Finance, AI, and Global Careers

Igor Vyshnevskyi, Ph.D.

Sogang University, Geppert School of International Studies

Albatross Seminar

May 20, 2026

International Commerce Today

Then: Core Transaction Work

Trade

Cross-border goods exchange

Import / Export

Documentation and operations

Logistics

Transport and delivery coordination

Accounting

Recording and compliance

Now: Strategy + Technology + Global Systems

Artificial Intelligence

Data Science

FinTech

Global Finance

Digital Payments

Geopolitics

Central Banking

Climate Risk

Global Supply Chains

International commerce today is not only about goods crossing borders. It is also about information, finance, technology, and global coordination.

A Question

What skills will matter most in the next 10 years?

Think first.

Fast poll (raise your hand):

- A) AI/Tech skills
- B) Communication/leadership skills
- C) Balanced mix of both

My Journey

Academic & Professional Path

Ukraine
Early foundation

Export-Import Banking
Global transactions

KDI School
Advanced training

Banking Sector
Industry experience

Central Bank of Ukraine
Policy perspective

Sogang University
Teaching + research

What I learned

Career reality: paths are not linear.

Portable advantage: analytical thinking works in every role.

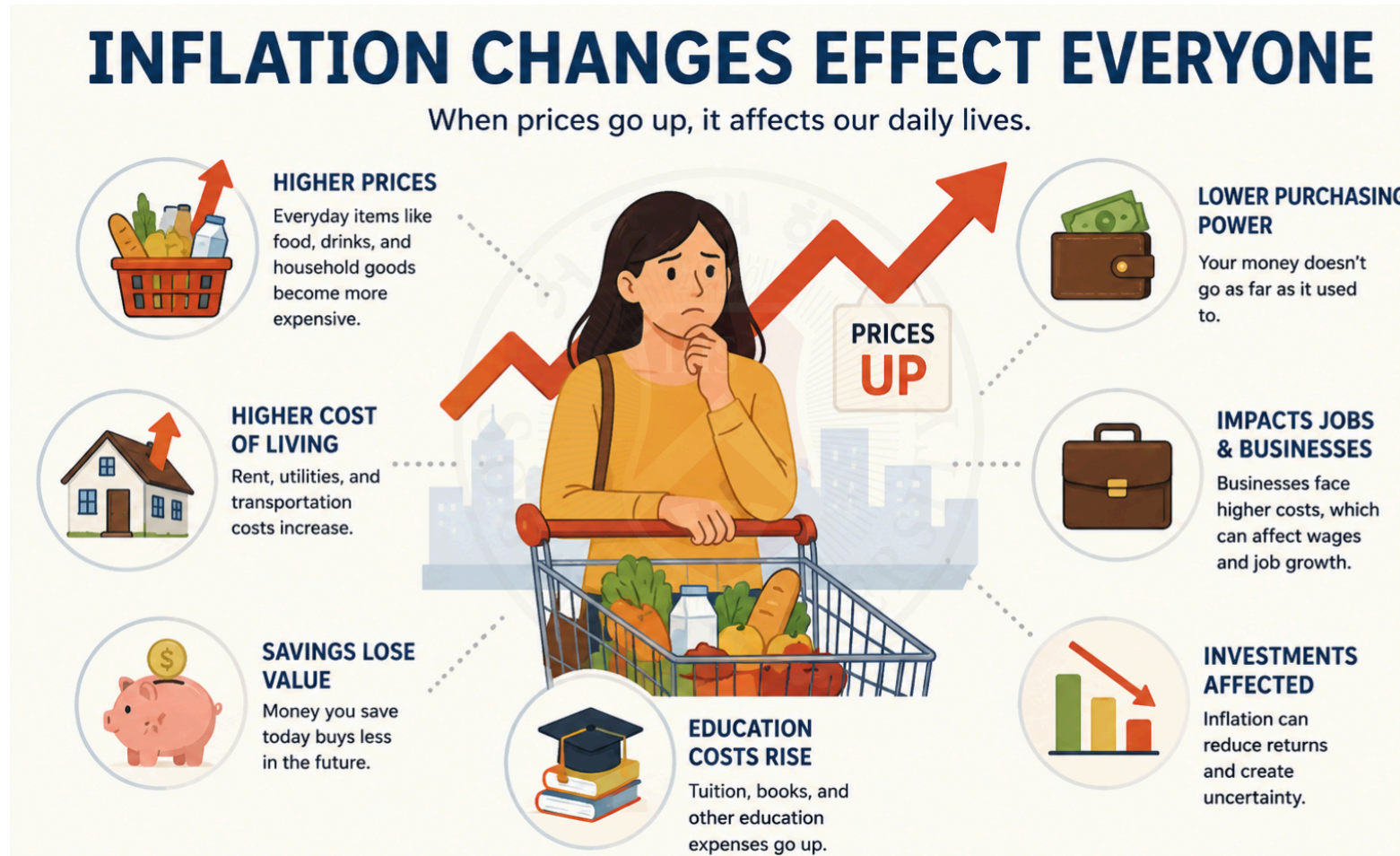
Multiplier: communication + collaboration accelerate impact.

Constant: technology reshapes every field.

Global edge: international exposure opens doors.

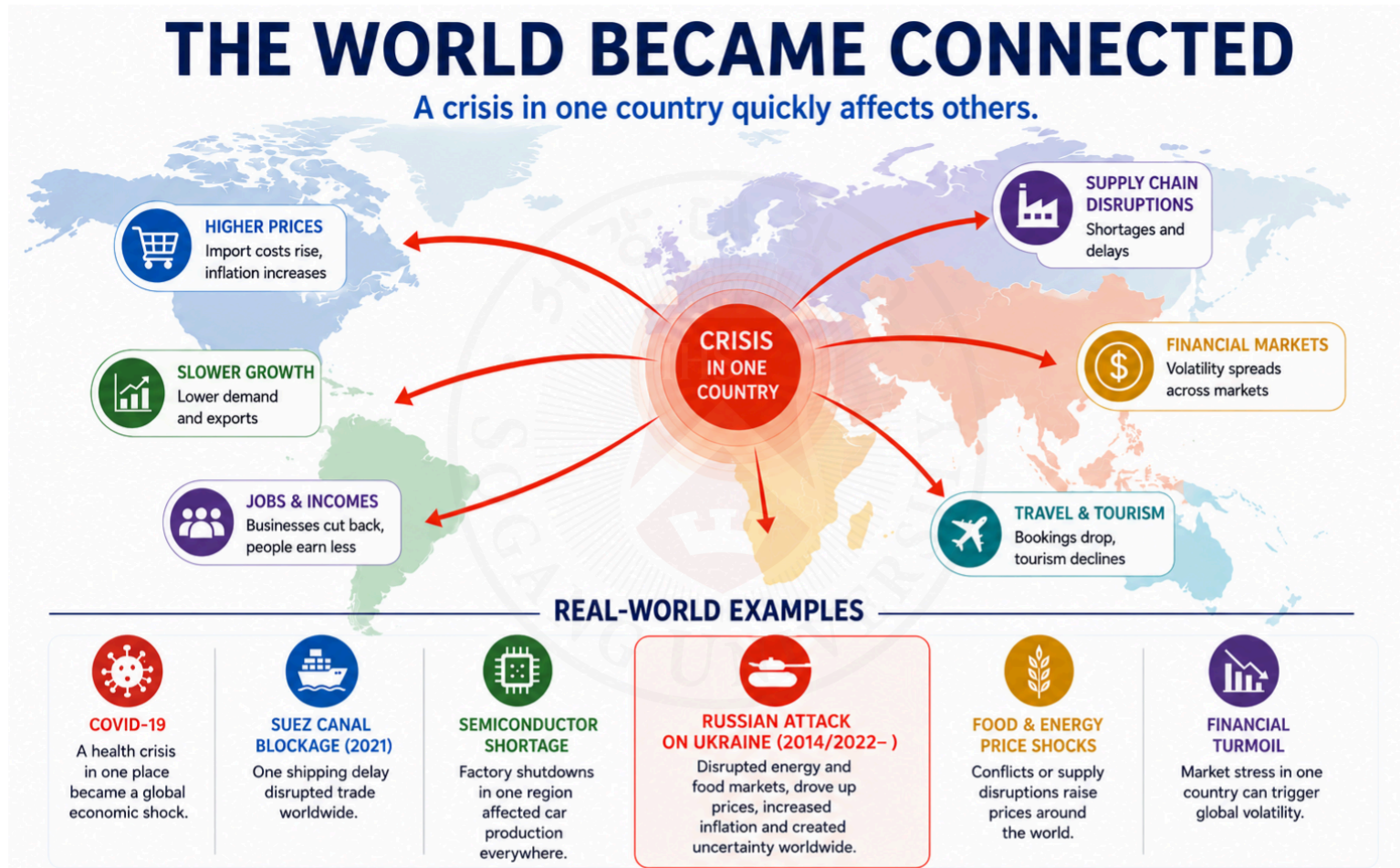
Key message: Every career path is unique—adaptability and learning from each step matter more than a perfect plan.

Macro Trends Affecting Commerce



How to read this visual: Inflation is not only a macroeconomic number. It directly affects households through living costs, savings, education expenses, and job conditions.

Global Village



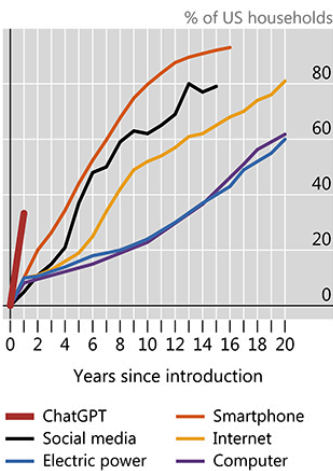
Key takeaway: Global interdependence means local shocks become global outcomes. Track the channels from one crisis to prices, jobs, financial markets, and supply chains.

AI is Changing Commerce

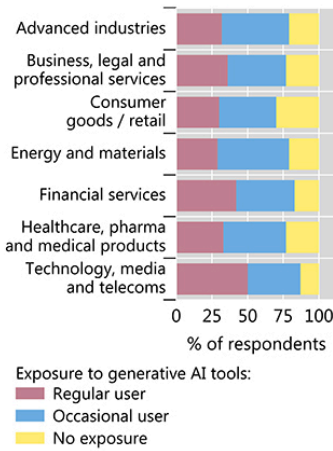
The adoption of AI¹

Graph 1

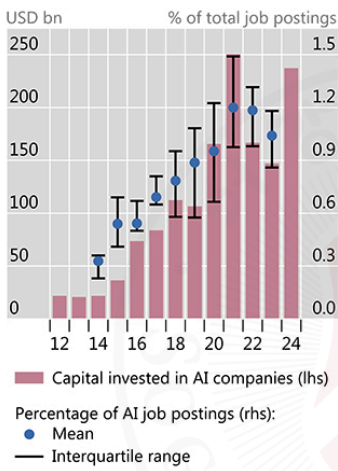
A. The adoption of AI is happening fast...



B. ...and in all sectors...



C. ...while investments in AI companies and job openings soar

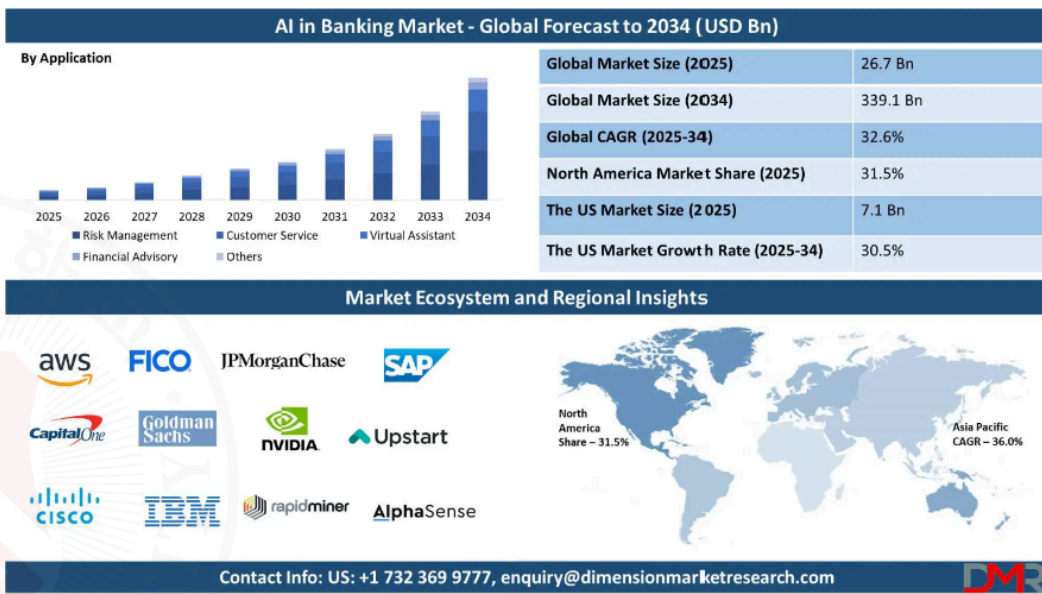


¹ See technical annex for details.

Sources: Allcot (2023); Comin and Hobijn (2004); Maslej et al (2024); McKinsey & Company (2023); IMF, *World Economic Outlook*; US Census Bureau, *Current Population Survey*; International Telecommunication Union (ITU); PitchBook Data Inc; Our World in Data; Statista, *Digital Market Insights*; BIS.

© Bank for International Settlements

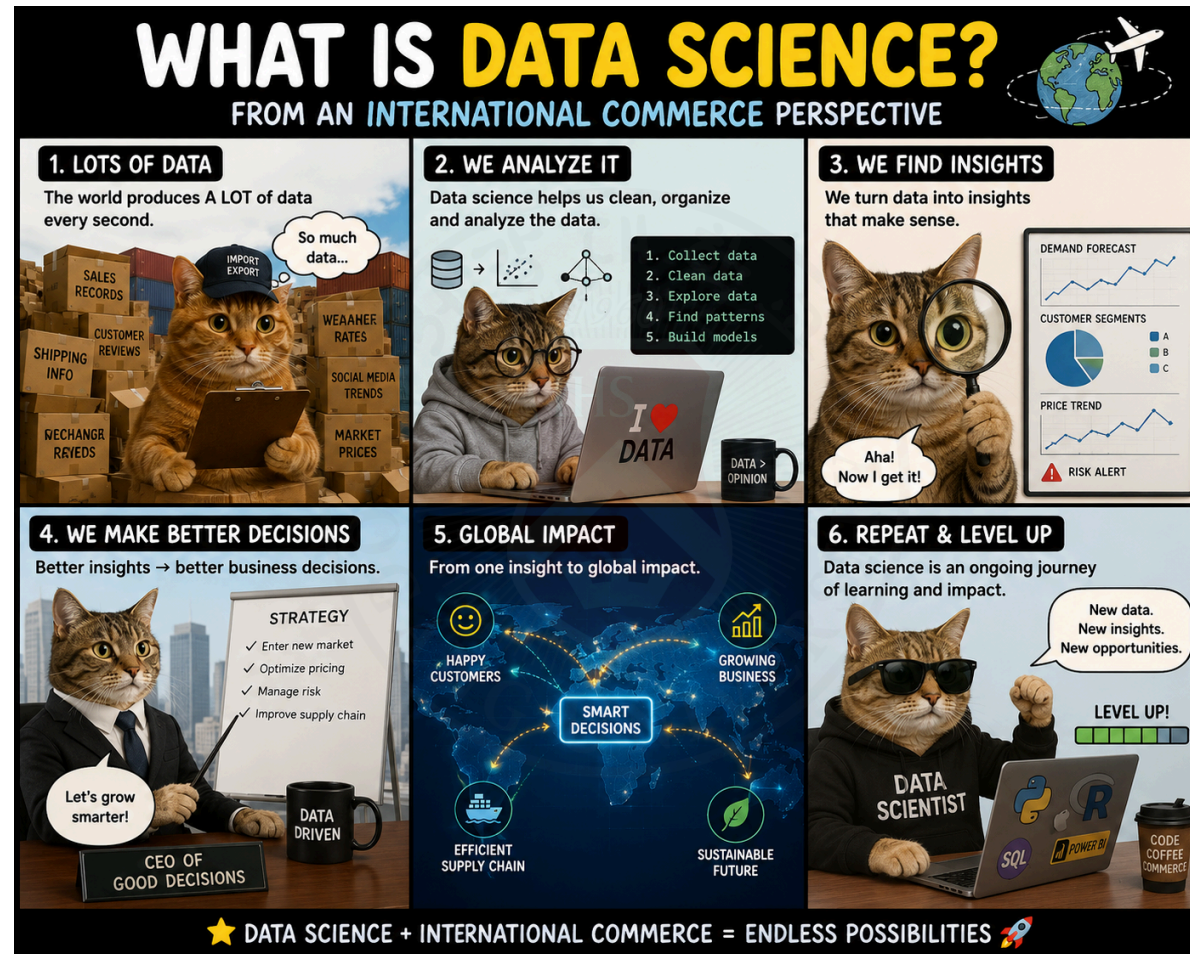
Source: BIS.



Source: DMR.

Think-Reflect:
AI is not replacing all jobs, but people who can work with AI gain a strong edge.

Data Science in Commerce



Interpretation: Data science is a cycle, not a one-time step: collect data, analyze patterns, produce insights, decide, and iterate.

Future Careers

Traditional Careers

Banking

Credit, markets, risk, operations

Trade

Cross-border business and contracts

Consulting

Problem-solving for firms and public sector

Government / IOs

Policy, regulation, development

Emerging Careers

FinTech

AI in Finance

Economic Data Analyst

ESG & Climate Finance

Digital Policy

Risk Analytics

Key idea: The best careers blend traditional foundations with new skills—be ready to adapt and combine both.

Important Message

Do not rush to define your entire future immediately.

University is your low-risk high-growth lab.

Explore

Experiment

Build skills

Learn how to think

Network

Enjoy the process

Core Skills in 2030

What employers expect

According to the World Economic Forum, the most important future skills combine:

AI & Big Data

Understand model outputs and limits

Tech Literacy

Use digital tools effectively

Analytical Thinking

Frame and solve real problems

Creative Thinking

Generate useful alternatives

Lifelong Learning

Update yourself continuously

Resilience

Adapt under uncertainty

Key message

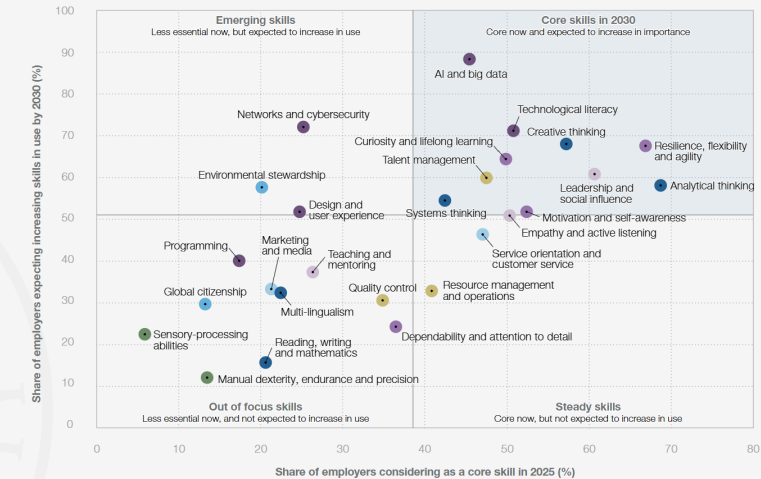
International Commerce students need both:

Formula: technical skills + human skills = durable career advantage

FIGURE 3.6

Core skills in 2030

Share of employers considering skills to be a core skill in 2025 and share of employers expecting skills to increase in importance by 2030.



Source

World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs Survey 2024.

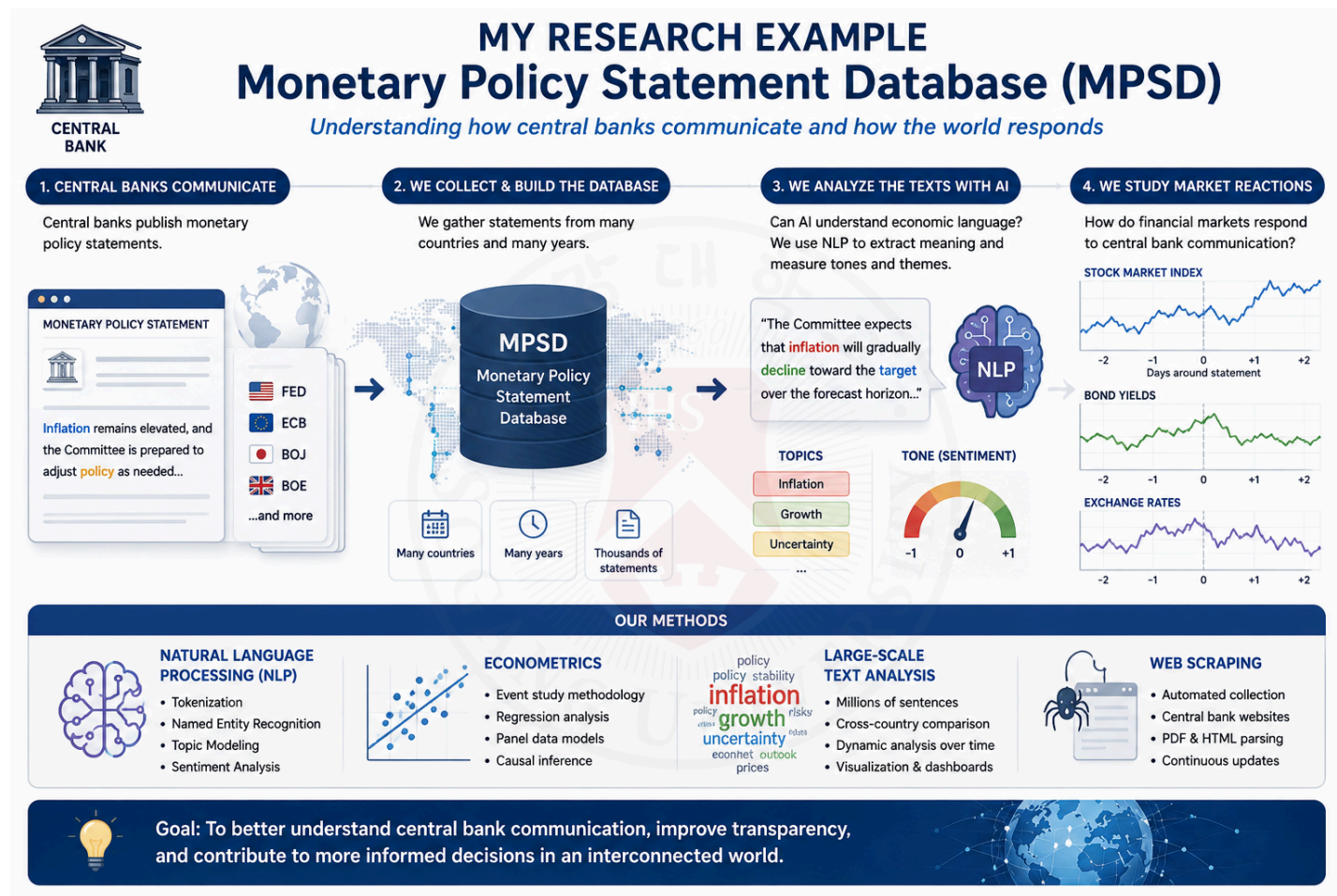
Note

The Future of Jobs Survey uses the World Economic Forum's Global Skills Taxonomy. Bold lines represent the median values across all skills.

Return on skills is higher than return on knowledge.

Source: World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs Survey 2024.

Research in Practice



Research workflow in one line: central bank statements -> NLP and econometrics -> measurable market reactions. This is how commerce, policy, and data science connect in practice.

Final Advice

1. Standards

Build your own principles.

2. Challenge

Try difficult things early.

3. Communication

Use it.

4. Teamwork

Collaborate with others.

5. Mastery

Build real knowledge and skills.

6. Professionalism

Aim for excellence in any path.



Exit ticket: Write one concrete action you will take in the next 7 days.

The background of the slide features a large, faint, light-gray watermark of the Sogang University seal. The seal is circular, with the university's name in Korean '서강대학교' at the top and 'SOGANG UNIVERSITY' at the bottom. In the center is a red shield with a white cross and the letters 'IHS'. The year '1960' is inscribed above the shield.

Thank You!

Questions?